

COMS W4170 Midterm Warmup — Page 1: User details & Search conce

User details

Name: _____

UNI: _____

Role/Context: Columbia student (or NYC student/remote worker) looking for a study spot.

Device: Phone + laptop; often searching on mobile while walking between classes.

1) What data will your website allow users to search?

NYC study spots (libraries, campus buildings, cafés that allow studying, etc.). Users can search/filter by neighborhood, proximity to subway, hours (incl. late-night), Wi-Fi quality, outlet availability, noise level, seating capacity, and tags like “quiet”, “group-friendly”, or “lots of outlets”.

2) Who would want to search this and why?

Example user: a Columbia student with a gap between classes who needs a reliable place to work. They want somewhere nearby (e.g., Morningside Heights), quiet enough to focus, with strong Wi-Fi, and open late so they don't get kicked out mid-session.

3) What information on this page should help the user issue a new search? Why?

Searchable/clickable info on each result page should include:

- Neighborhood + nearby subway lines: lets users quickly pivot to “near where I am now.”
- Hours (and ‘open now’): supports time-critical decisions.
- Wi-Fi / outlets / noise scores: makes it easy to compare and refine (“quiet + strong Wi-Fi”).
- Tags (quiet, big tables, group study, etc.): fast re-search by intent.
- Similar spots / ‘people also studied at’: enables exploration without starting over.

These are useful because they are the most common decision factors when choosing a study spot and they translate naturally into filters for a follow-up search.

COMS W4170 Midterm Warmup — Page 2: Design (no annotations)

Paste an image/screenshot of your design here (no annotation).

DESIGN IMAGE PLACEHOLDER

COMS W4170 Midterm Warmup — Page 3: Annotated design

Paste the same design with annotations showing the required visual information design.

Tip: annotate hierarchy (type scale), grouping (Gestalt), color/contrast, and affordances (filters, search box, tags).

ANNOTATED DESIGN IMAGE PLACEHOLDER